

ITALY

Visa Application Guide for Pakistani Applicants

Student (National/Long-Stay) & Short-Stay (Schengen Tourist) Visas

This guide summarises the official requirements published by the Consulate General of Italy in Karachi and the Embassy of Italy in Islamabad (via their VFS Global one-pager information pages), for two visa categories most relevant to Pakistani applicants: the **Short-Stay Schengen (tourist) visa** and the **National (Study) visa**. It is intended as a practical companion while you prepare your application — always cross-check with the official links listed at the end before you submit.

Two Application Centres

Pakistani applicants apply through the **VFS Global-run Visa Application Centres** tied to two separate Italian missions: the **Consulate General of Italy in Karachi** (for applicants resident in Sindh/Balochistan) and the **Embassy of Italy in Islamabad** (for applicants resident in Punjab, KP, Islamabad Capital Territory, Gilgit-Baltistan and AJK). Fees, checklists and processing guidance differ slightly between the two — always use the centre that matches your residence.

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1. Know Your Visa Type

Italy is a member of the Schengen Area. Which visa you need depends on the purpose and length of your stay.

Visa Type	Purpose	Maximum Duration
Schengen Short-Stay Visa ("C")	Tourism, visiting friends/family, business, medical, religious, sports, short conferences, or study/training under 90 days	Up to 90 days in any 180-day period, across the whole Schengen Area
National/Long-Stay Visa ("D") — Study	Enrolment on a course of study in Italy lasting more than 90 days	Duration of study programme (followed by a residence permit — permesso di soggiorno — obtained after arrival)

✓ Rule of thumb

If your Italian course or programme is **90 days or shorter**, you apply for a short-stay (Schengen) study visa. If it is **longer than 90 days** (a full academic year, a degree programme, a long language course, etc.), you must apply for the National/Long-Stay study visa described in Section 4.

2. Islamabad vs Karachi — Which Jurisdiction Applies to You

Your visa application must be lodged at the Visa Application Centre linked to the Italian mission that has consular jurisdiction over your place of residence in Pakistan.

Jurisdiction	Covers	Key notes
Consulate General of Italy, Karachi	Applicants resident in Sindh and Balochistan	Service fee: €30/application (cash, at VFS centre). Recommends applying 3–4 weeks before travel.
Embassy of Italy, Islamabad	Applicants resident in Punjab, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, Islamabad Capital Territory, Gilgit-Baltistan and Azad Jammu & Kashmir	Service fee: €30/application (cash, local currency, at VFS centre). Requires applying at least 30 days before travel; applications with less than 30 days' notice are not accepted.

Both jurisdictions use VFS Global as the outsourced Visa Application Centre operator. Application forms, checklists and fee schedules are hosted on separate VFS one-pager sites for each city — make sure you are reading the page for your own jurisdiction.

3. Short-Stay (Schengen Tourist) Visa

For travel to Italy (and the rest of the Schengen Area) as a tourist — an organised tour or independently booked trip — for up to 90 days.

3.1 Visa & Service Fees

Visa Category	Visa Fee (EUR)	Visa Fee (approx. PKR)*
Schengen Visa — adult	€80	PKR 24,780
Schengen Visa — children 6–12 years	€40	PKR 12,390
Schengen Visa — children under 6 years	€0 (exempt)	PKR 0

*PKR amounts are set at the consulate's exchange rate (effective 01 July 2023 at time of publication) and are revised periodically — confirm the current rate with VFS before paying. A separate VFS service fee of **€30 per application** is also charged in cash at the Visa Application Centre in addition to the visa fee.

3.2 Who is exempt from the visa fee?

- Children under 6 years of age
- Pupils, students and their accompanying teachers travelling for study or educational training
- Researchers from third countries conducting scientific research (as defined by EU recommendation 2005/761/EC)
- Representatives of non-profit organisations aged 25 or under, attending seminars/conferences/sports/cultural/educational events
- Participants aged 25 or under in non-profit-organised seminars, conferences, sports, cultural or educational events
- Spouses, children and dependent ascendants of an EU/EEA national exercising free-movement rights in Italy, when visiting that person

3.3 Documents Required

- Short-stay visa application form, fully completed (address, phone numbers, parents' names). For minors, the form must be signed by **both parents**.
- Two recent (max. 6 months old) colour passport-size photographs on a white background, unedited (see Section 7 for full specifications)
- Original passport valid for at least 3 months beyond the visa's expiry, with at least 2 blank pages
- If you were refused a Schengen visa in the last 2 years: a written explanation of the trip purpose and the earlier refusal
- Original and photocopy of your NADRA Family Registration Certificate (English, or with certified translation)
- For minors under 18 travelling with only one parent: written consent from the other parent plus a copy of that parent's CNIC
- Signed letter from your employer (name, position, salary, employment duration, employer's address/contact, purpose & duration of the trip) — or, if you are a student, a signed letter from your school/college/university
- Copy of return flight booking(s)
- Proof of accommodation for the entire trip (confirmed hotel booking or rental agreement showing your name, dates and address) — or a detailed itinerary if travelling on a package tour
- Travel/medical insurance of at least €30,000 covering the whole Schengen stay, including repatriation (see Section 6)

- Copy of your CNIC
- Proof of personal income: bank account maintenance certificate, bank statements for the last 6 months, National Tax Number certificate for the last 2 years with proof of tax paid, and your last 3 salary slips

■ Incomplete files are rejected

An application submitted without the complete set of documents will be rejected outright, and any forged or fake documents are reported to the relevant authorities. Third-country nationals resident in Pakistan must additionally prove the legality and duration of their residence here.

3.4 Processing Time

Karachi jurisdiction: apply at least **3–4 weeks** before your planned travel date. Islamabad jurisdiction: apply at least **30 days** in advance — applications with less than 30 days' notice before the intended travel date will not be accepted.

3.5 Forms to Download

- Schengen Visa Application Form
- Personal Details Form (mandatory, Karachi jurisdiction)
- Host Declaration / Invitation Letter for Tourist Visa (if being hosted by someone in Italy)
- List of approved insurance companies for Schengen visas
- Financial resources requirement sheet (Islamabad jurisdiction)

Download links are hosted on the VFS Global one-pager sites listed in Section 11 — use the form set that matches your jurisdiction (Karachi or Islamabad).

4. Student / National (Long-Stay) Visa

This is a National ("D") visa for study programmes in Italy lasting **more than 90 days** (e.g. a full degree, academic year, or extended language course). This section reflects the Islamabad jurisdiction one-pager; applicants under Karachi jurisdiction should confirm the equivalent checklist with their VFS centre as some documents may be listed slightly differently.

4.1 Visa Fee

Visa Category	Visa Fee (EUR)	Visa Fee (approx. PKR)
National (Long-Stay) Visa	€116	PKR 35,940

A VFS service fee of €30 (in local currency, cash) also applies. Fees are effective from 01 July 2023 and the exchange rate is set by the Embassy of Italy and may change without notice.

4.2 Documents Required (Study Visa Checklist)

- Visa application form, completed and signed
- Two recent passport-size photographs
- Passport (or travel document) valid for at least 3 months after the visa's expiry
- Admission/acceptance letter from the Italian university or institute
- Proof of a study grant (if awarded) by the Italian government, a recognised foundation/cultural institute, an international organisation, a foreign government, or a university — or, if no grant or an insufficient one, proof of your own or your family's financial means (see Section 5)
- Proof of appropriate lodging arrangements in Italy, plus funds for the return journey (a return air ticket can serve as proof of the latter)
- Travel/health insurance valid across the Schengen states, covering your full stay, with a minimum liability of €30,000

No fee for stays under 90 days

No visa fee is charged for a study visa covering 90 days or less — in that case you would apply for the short-stay Schengen study visa instead of the National visa described here.

■ A complete file does not guarantee approval

The Embassy may request additional documents at its discretion. Submitting a complete file and holding a pre-enrolment letter from an Italian university does **not** guarantee the visa will be issued.

4.3 Processing Time

Each National (long-stay) visa application is assessed individually, so there is no fixed processing time. Applicants are strongly advised not to confirm flights or other travel arrangements until the visa has actually been granted.

4.4 Forms to Download

- Long-Stay (National) Visa Application Form
- List of approved insurance companies

For general rules on visa categories beyond this checklist, the Islamabad one-pager also points applicants to the Italian Ministry of Foreign Affairs' visa portal (vistoperitalia.esteri.it).

5. Financial Evidence Requirements

Under Italian Interior Ministry rules (Directive of 1 March 2000, based on Legislative Decree 286/1998), every traveller must show they have enough money to cover their stay and their return journey. This applies to entry into Italy generally, and evidence can be requested again by Border Police even after the visa is issued.

Length of Stay	One Traveller	Two or More Travellers (per group)
1–5 days (fixed amount)	€269.60	€212.81
6–10 days (per person/day)	€44.93	€26.33
11–20 days (fixed) + daily/person	€51.64 + €36.67/day	€25.82 + €22.21/day
Over 20 days (fixed) + daily/person	€206.58 + €27.89/day	€118.79 + €17.04/day

Acceptable evidence includes:

- Liquid cash
- Bank guarantees, insurance-policy guarantees or equivalent credit instruments
- Vouchers for prepaid services
- Other documents proving access to sources of income in Italy

■ No proof, no visa — or turned away at the border

Failure to demonstrate sufficient means of subsistence is grounds for refusal of the visa, and even a traveller who reaches the border without adequate proof can be formally denied entry by Border Police.

6. Travel & Health Insurance

- Minimum cover: **€30,000**, valid across the whole Schengen Area (not Italy alone)
- Must cover medical treatment, hospitalisation and repatriation costs
- Must be valid for the entire duration of your intended stay
- The policy should come from a company on the VFS/Embassy's approved insurance-provider list — check the current list published alongside your jurisdiction's one-pager before purchasing a policy

7. Photo Specifications

- Sharp focus, clear, good contrast
- Printed on high-quality photo paper, high resolution
- In colour, 35–40 mm wide
- No older than 6 months, and must resemble the applicant
- Taken facing the camera directly, against a light background
- Whole head and top of shoulders visible; face occupies 70–80% of the frame
- Eyes open and clearly visible; hair must not cover the eyes
- Glasses are allowed if eyes are clearly visible — lenses must not be tinted, frames must not cover the eyes, and there must be no glare/reflection

- Religious headwear is allowed provided the chin, forehead and both cheeks are clearly visible, with no shadows falling across the face

Photos that do not meet these specifications will make your application incomplete. A photo booth meeting these requirements is available on-site at the Visa Application Centre.

8. Minors Travelling / Applying

- The visa application form for a minor (under 18) must be **signed by both parents**.
- If a minor is travelling with only **one** parent, the application must include the other parent's **written consent** plus a photocopy of that parent's CNIC.
- A Birth Certificate (issued by NADRA) is required as proof of the parent-child relationship where applicable, alongside the Family Registration Certificate.
- For the visa to be printed, a minor's passport must be signed (or thumb-impressed) by the minor themselves — not by a parent — as Pakistani passports are only valid with the holder's own signature or thumb impression.

Plan ahead for minors

Because consent letters and NADRA certificates can take time to arrange, start gathering these documents for a minor applicant well before your target submission date.

9. Mandatory Polio Vaccination Requirement

■ Applies to all applicants from Pakistan

Applicants who are residents of — or have stayed for more than 4 weeks in — Afghanistan, Kenya, the Democratic Republic of the Congo, Nigeria, **Pakistan**, Somalia or Syria must hold an **international polio vaccination certificate** showing they were vaccinated against polio **between 4 weeks and 12 months before their travel date**.

This certificate is an additional eligibility requirement both for the visa to be issued and for crossing the external Schengen border on arrival — keep the original certificate with your travel documents, not just a photocopy in your visa file.

10. Application Workflow (Step-by-Step)

- 1. Identify your jurisdiction** — Determine whether Karachi (Sindh/Balochistan) or Islamabad (Punjab, KP, ICT, GB, AJK) has consular authority over your place of residence.
- 2. Choose the correct visa category** — Short-stay Schengen (tourist, or study ≤90 days) vs. National/Long-Stay (study >90 days) — see Section 1.
- 3. Gather documents early** — Passport, photos, financial evidence, insurance, employer/university letters, NADRA documents, and (for Pakistan-based applicants) the polio vaccination certificate.
- 4. Book your VFS appointment** — Book through the VFS Global centre for your jurisdiction, respecting the minimum lead times (3–4 weeks for Karachi; at least 30 days for Islamabad).
- 5. Pay the visa fee and VFS service fee** — Both are paid in cash, in PKR, at the Visa Application Centre on the day of your appointment.
- 6. Attend your appointment** — Submit your full document set, have your photo taken at the centre if needed, and provide biometrics as required.
- 7. Track and collect your passport** — Use the tracking service provided by VFS/the consulate to monitor your application status until your passport (with visa, if approved) is ready for collection.

11. Official Source List

This guide was compiled from the following official VFS Global one-pager pages for the Italian missions in Pakistan. Always check these pages directly for the latest fees, forms and checklists before applying, as requirements can change.

Italy Visa Information — Karachi — Tourism: <https://visa.vfsglobal.com/one-pager/italy/pakistan/karachi/english/tourist.html>

Italy Visa Information — Islamabad — Tourism:

<https://visa.vfsglobal.com/one-pager/italy/pakistan/islamabad/english/tourist.html>

Italy Visa Information — Islamabad — Short-Term Visa (category index):

<https://visa.vfsglobal.com/one-pager/italy/pakistan/islamabad/english/Short-term-visa.html>

Italy Visa Information — Islamabad — Study:

<https://visa.vfsglobal.com/one-pager/italy/pakistan/islamabad/english/Study.html>

Note: PKR fee figures, exchange rates and lead-time policies are those published at the time this guide was compiled and are subject to change by the consulate/embassy without notice. Always confirm current fees and required lead times directly on the official pages above before booking your appointment.

This document is an independent informational summary for Pakistani visa applicants and is not an official publication of the Italian Government, its Embassy/Consulates, or VFS Global.